

68320 Nanofabrication and and Nanocharacterization Techniques

Tutorial 2 cheat-sheet: How to use AI to help you in this subject

first LLM prompt, before coding was done

I created a new empty python file in VScode. I need to plot some data that is in a text file and do some curve fitting and basic analysis (integration under curves....), and ultimately export plots in PDF format. I am working on a mac. What are the best options for this? (don't code yet)

AI-assisted coding in VScode

LLM output

Python code written by AI

Mac Terminal output

AI mode ("Agent") & model ("Claude Sonnet 4")

```
Tute2.py 2 x
Users > 112289 > Downloads > 68320 > 68320 2025 > Tutorials 2025 > Tute 2 - CASINO > CASINodata > Tute2.py >
1 import os
2 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
3 import numpy as np
4 from scipy import integrate
5 from scipy.optimize import curve_fit
6
7 def load_data(data_file):
8     """
9     Load and parse the BSEnergy.dat file
10    Returns energy and hits lists
11    """
12    energy = []
13    hits = []
14
15    with open(data_file, 'r') as file:
16        lines = file.readlines()
17
18    # Skip header lines and process data
19    data_started = False
20    for line in lines:
21        line = line.strip()
22
23        # Skip empty lines and headers
24        if not line or line.startswith('Backscattered') or line.startswith('Energy'):
25            continue
26
27        # Split the line into columns
28        parts = line.split()
29        if len(parts) >= 2:
30            try:
31                energy_val = float(parts[0])
```

CHAT

For plotting data, curve fitting, and analysis in Python on macOS, here are the best options:

Core Libraries

Matplotlib - The most popular plotting library

- Excellent for publication-quality plots
- Native PDF export support
- Highly customizable
- Works well with other scientific libraries

NumPy - Essential for numerical computations

- Array operations and mathematical functions
- Integration with all other scientific libraries

SciPy - For curve fitting and integration

- `scipy.optimize.curve_fit()` for curve fitting
- `scipy.integrate` for numerical integration
- Many statistical and scientific functions

Pandas - For data handling (if your text file is structured)

- Easy data reading with `pd.read_csv()` or `pd.read_table()`
- Data manipulation and cleaning
- Integrates seamlessly with matplotlib

PROBLEMS 2 OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS

```
End of file
(base) UTS039052:CASINodata 112289$ cd "/Users/112289/Downloads/68320/68320 2025/Tutorials 2025/Tute 2 - CASINO/CASINodata" && /opt/anaconda3/bin/conda run -p /opt/anaconda3 --no-capture-output python Tute2.py
=====
Loading and plotting BSE energy data
=====
Successfully loaded 300 data points
Energy range: 0.0 - 30.0 keV
Hits range: 0.000000 - 0.008337
Plot window opened successfully!
(base) UTS039052:CASINodata 112289$
```

+ v ... [] x

Copilot ⚠
Copilot ⚠

1 file changed

Tute2.py ~/Downloads/68320/68320 2025/Tutorials 2025/Tute 2 - CASINO/CASINodata

Add Context...

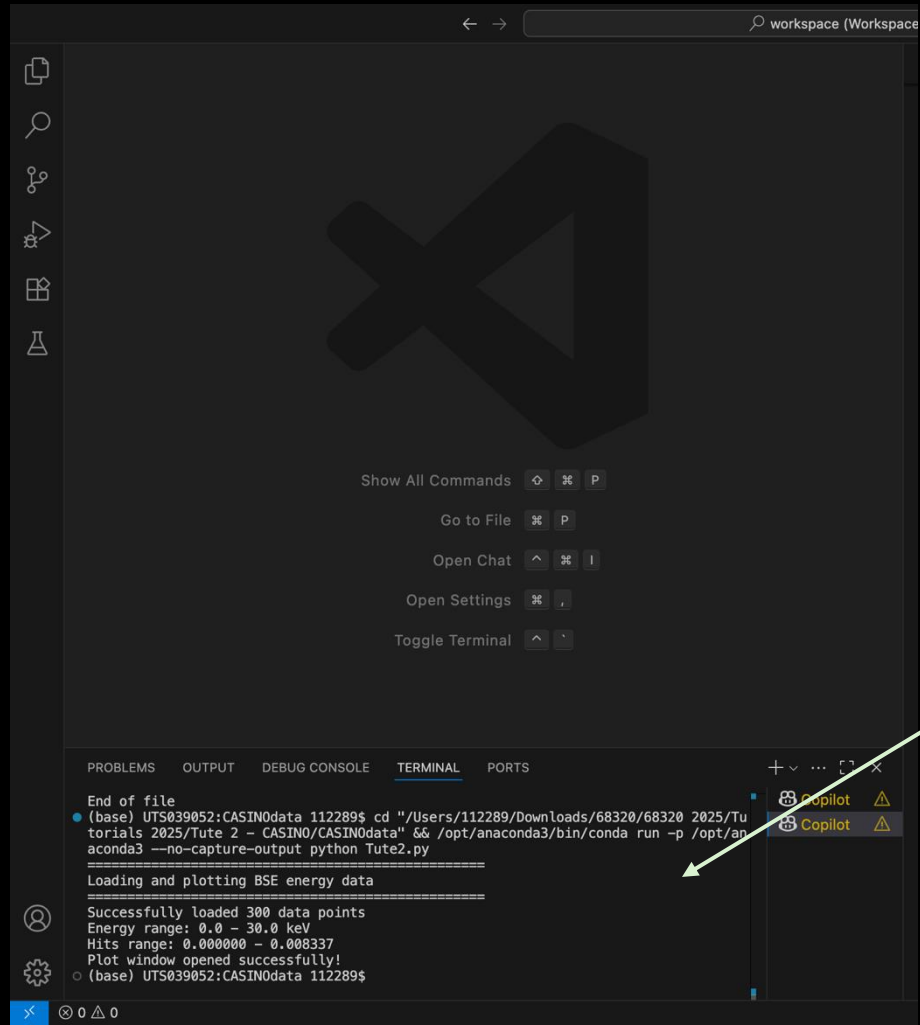
Tute2.py Current file

Edit files in your workspace in agent mode

Agent Claude Sonnet 4

End of LLM output to my 1st prompt

My 2nd prompt



Recommended Approach

Start with **matplotlib + numpy + scipy** as your core stack. Add **pandas** if your data is in a structured format (CSV-like). This combination will handle all your requirements efficiently and is the industry standard for scientific Python work.

Would you like me to help you set up the environment and start coding with these libraries?

Yes. First, can you write code that opens a console window, opens the file BSEnergy.dat (located in the same directory as the code Tute2.py) and displays the file contents?

Tute2.py:1

I'll help you write code to open and display the contents of the BSEnergy.dat file. First, let me configure the Python environment and then write the code.

> Configuring a Python Environment

Now I'll write the code to open and display the BSEnergy.dat file:

Tute2.py +44 -1

Now let's run the code to see the contents of the BSEnergy.dat file:

```
cd "/Users/112289/Downloads/68320/68320 2025/Tutorials 2025/Tute 2 - CASINO/CASIN0data" && /opt/anaconda3/bin/conda run -p /opt/anaconda3 --no-capture-output python Tute2.py
```

Perfect! The code successfully opened and displayed the contents of the BSEnergy.dat file.

Here's what we can see from the data:

1. **File Structure:** The file contains backscattered energy data with two columns:

Energy (keV) and Hits (counts)

1 file changed

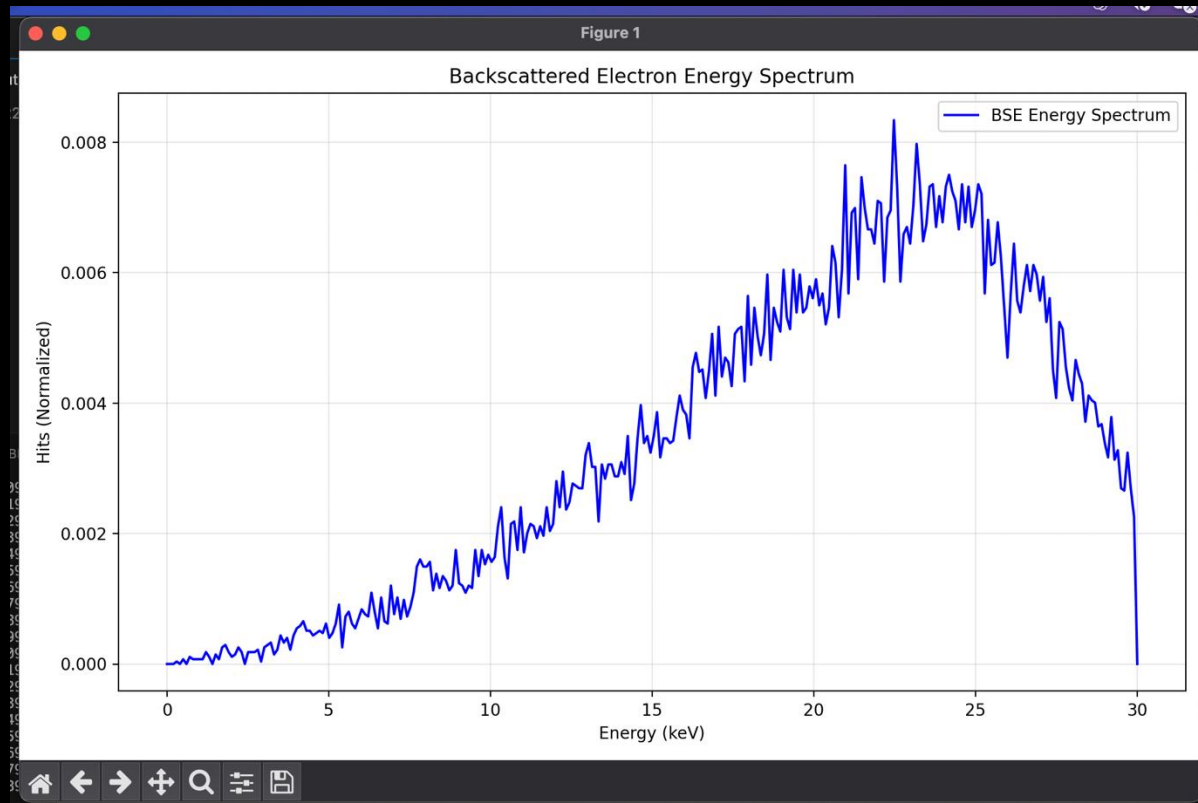
Tute2.py ~/Downloads/68320/68320 2025/Tutorials 2025/Tute 2 - CASINO/CASIN0data

Add Context...

Edit files in your workspace in agent mode

Agent Claude Sonnet 4

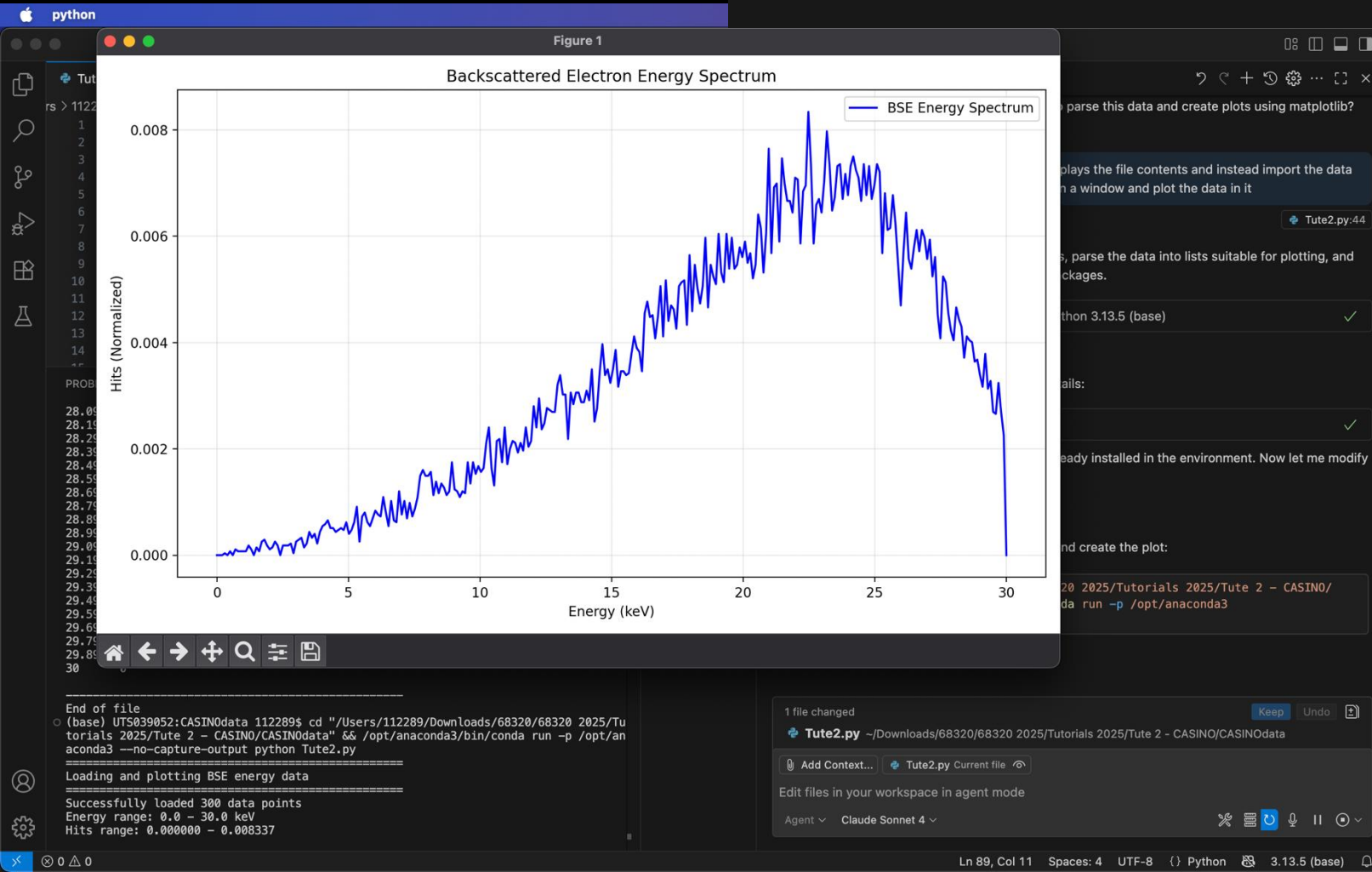
My next prompt was to import the data in the file and plot it...



Is the plot window visible on your screen? Would you like me to add any additional features like curve fitting or data analysis next?

Yes, I want to display the data as points (not a line) and fit a curve to it - perhaps try 2nd, 3rd and 4th order polynomial fits and display them all on the plot.

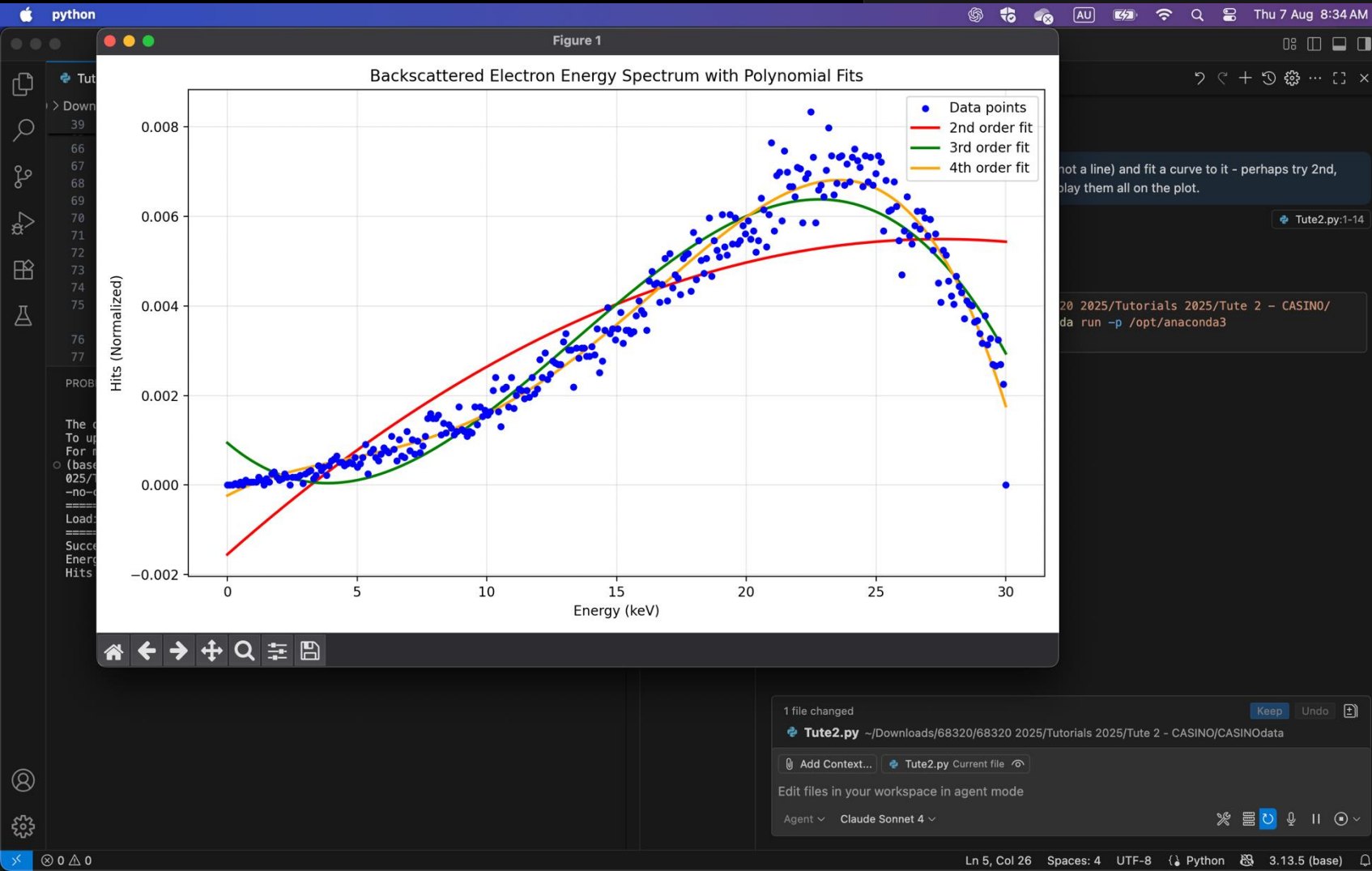
Tute2.py:1-14



You can now visually compare the data to the different polynomial fits. Let me know if you want to see fit coefficients, residuals, or further analysis!

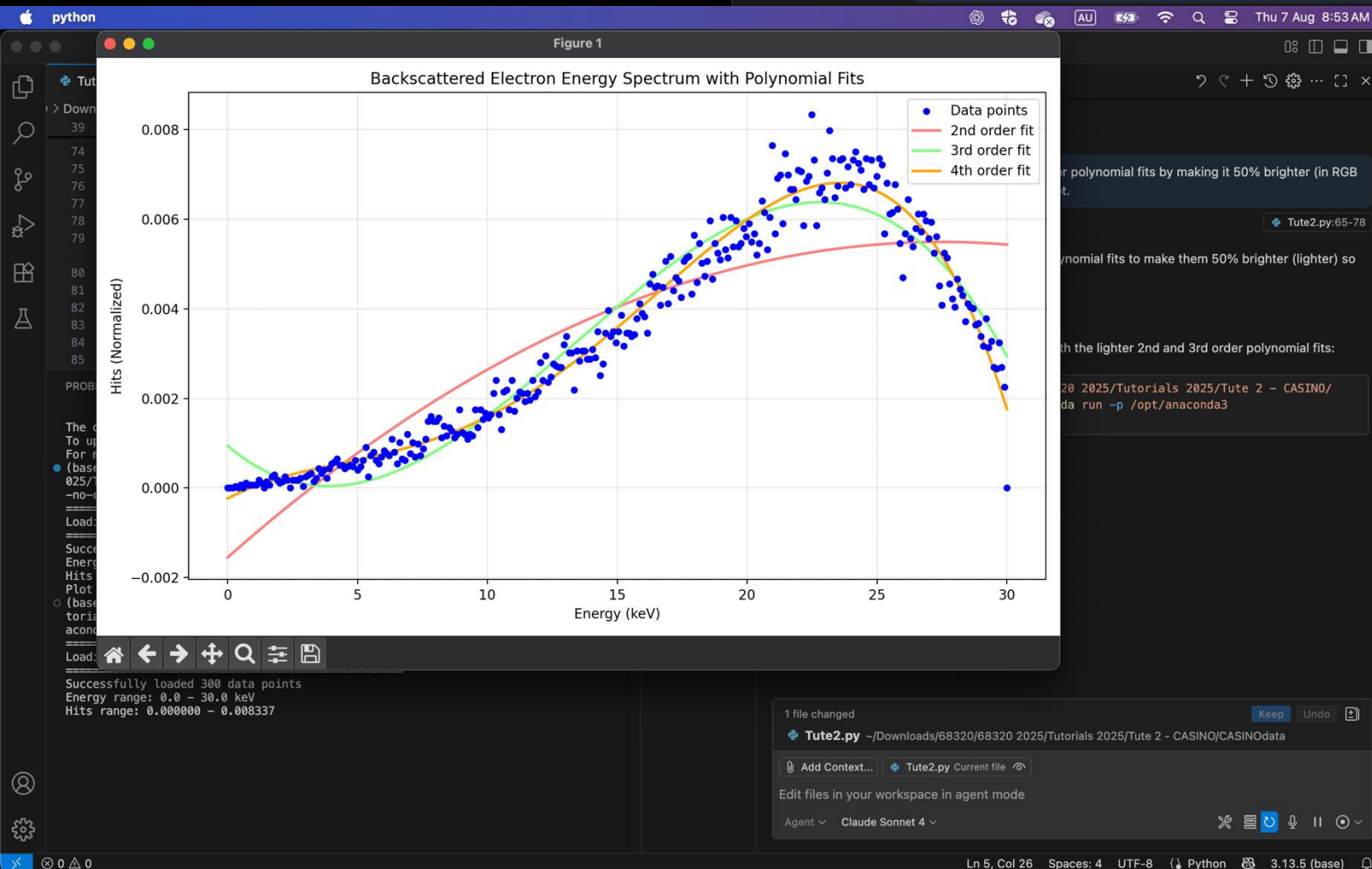
Change the color of the 2nd and 3rd order polynomial fits by making it 50% brighter (in RGB space), so they appear as faint on the plot.

Tute2.py:65-78



The 2nd and 3rd order polynomial fits now appear much fainter on the plot, making it easier to focus on the data points and the 4th order fit while still being able to see the comparison between different polynomial orders. The lighter colors were achieved by mixing the original red and green with white in RGB space to create the 50% brighter versions.

Integrate the raw data, and also the 4th order poly fit & display both results on the graph



Tute2.py:73-86

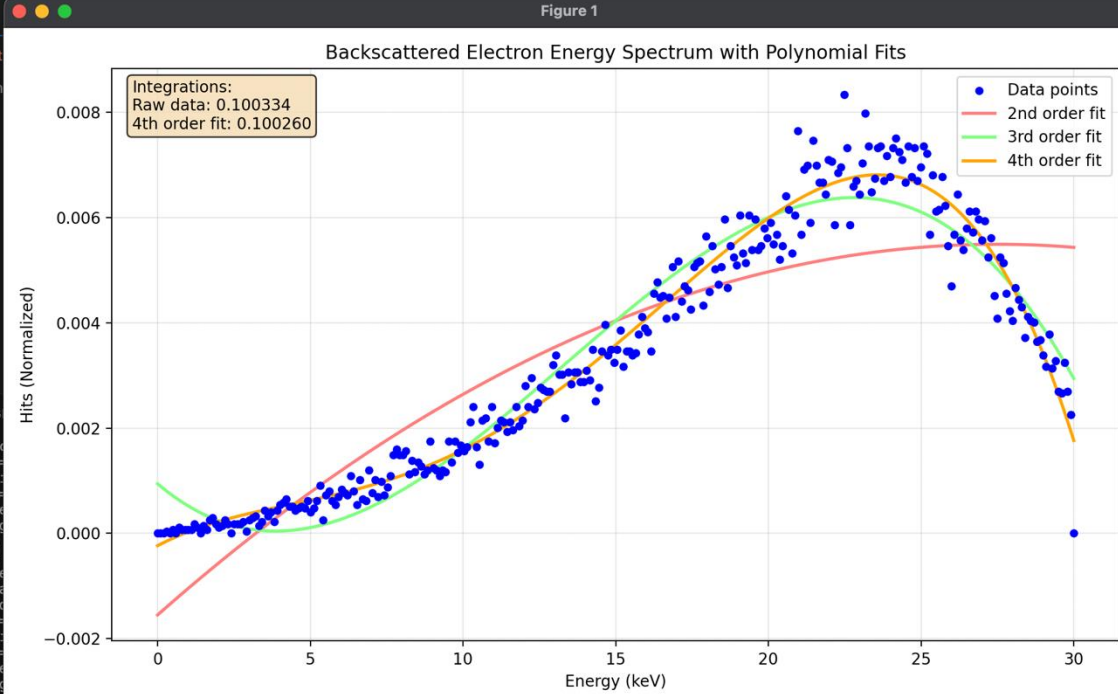
for polynomial fits by making it 50% brighter (in RGB
t.

Tute2.py:65-78

nomial fits to make them 50% brighter (lighter) so

th the lighter 2nd and 3rd order polynomial fits:

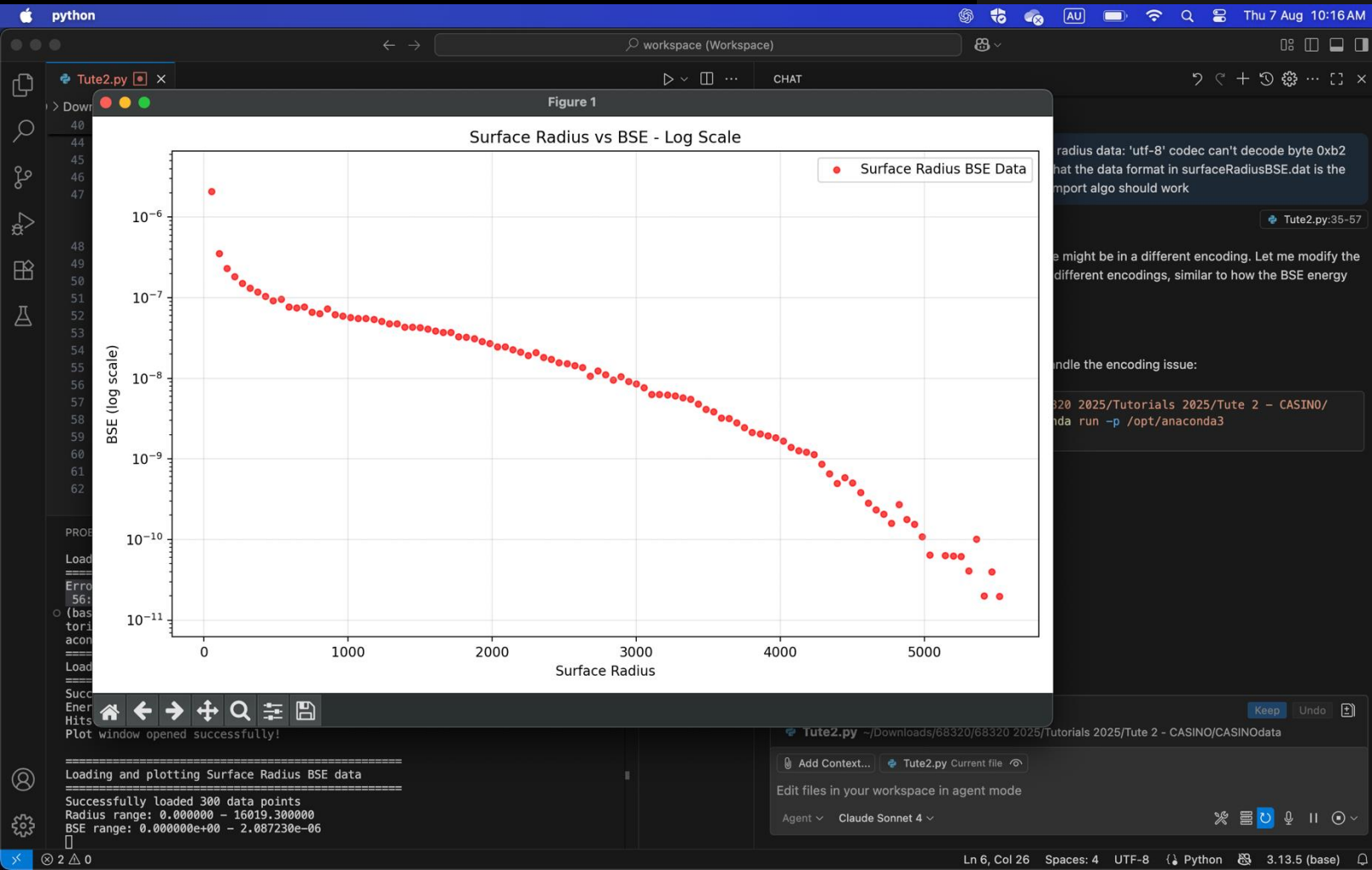
20 2025/Tutorials 2025/Tute 2 - CASINO/
da run -p /opt/anaconda3



The plot window should now be displaying both the visual fits and the quantitative integration results!

Leave the above code as is, and add code that does the following: (1) import data in the file surfaceRadiusBSE.dat, (2) plot it in a second window and make the y-axis log scale (set the min & max values on the y-axis using a smart algo that detects the minimum and maximum values in the dataset). Do not do any curve fitting or calculations yet.

[Tute2.py:1-23](#)



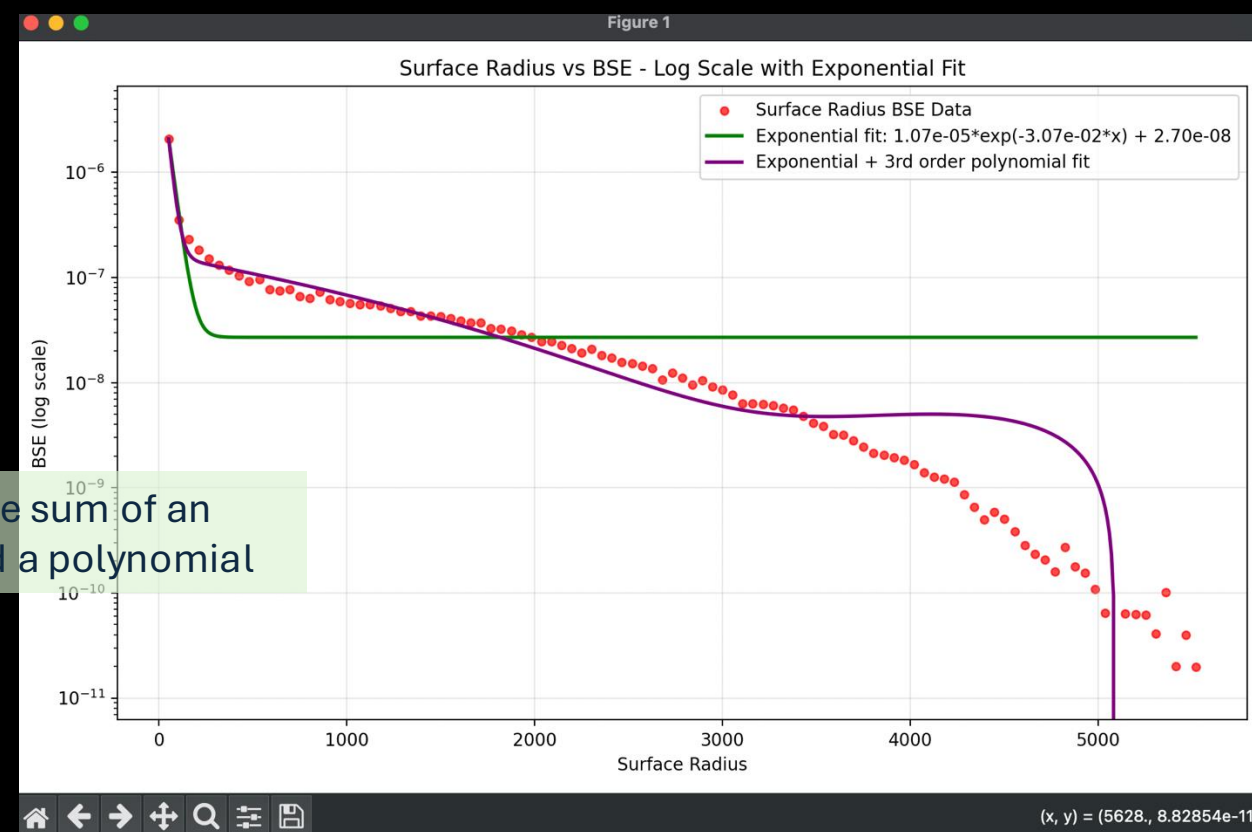
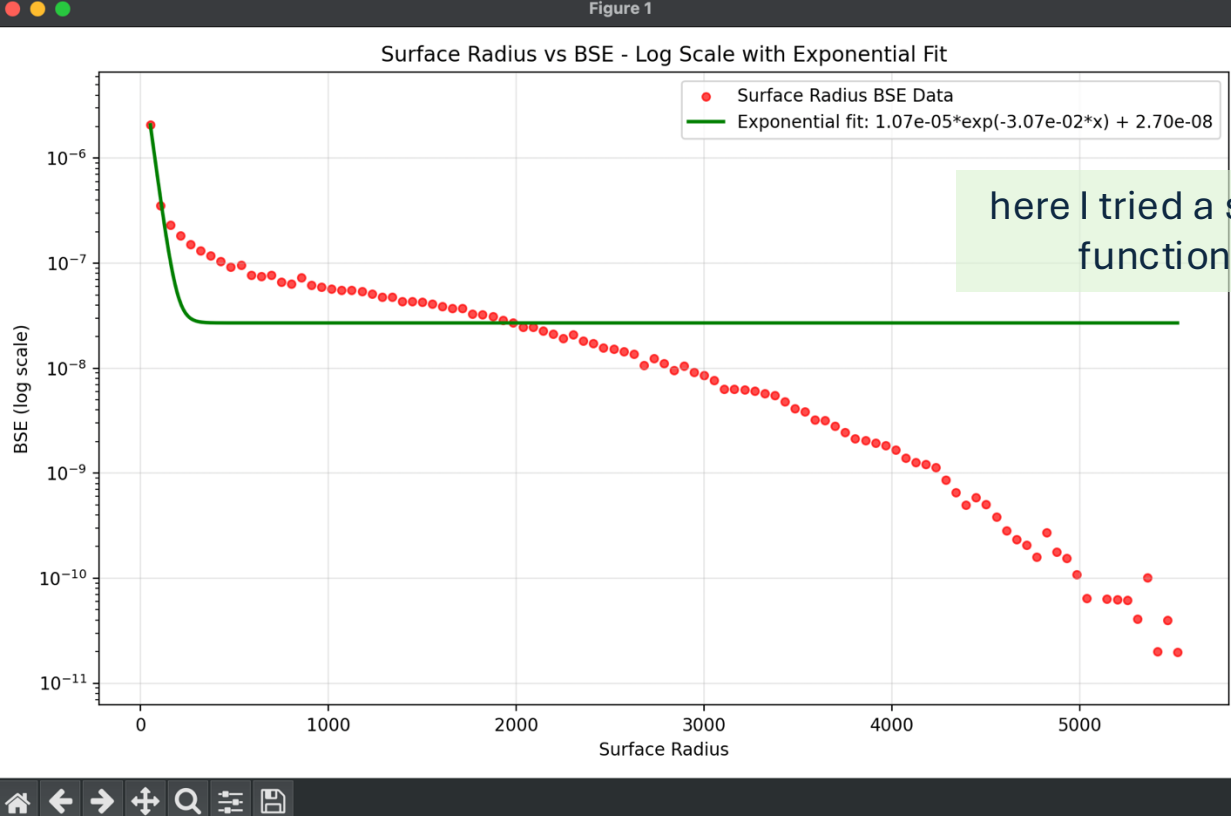
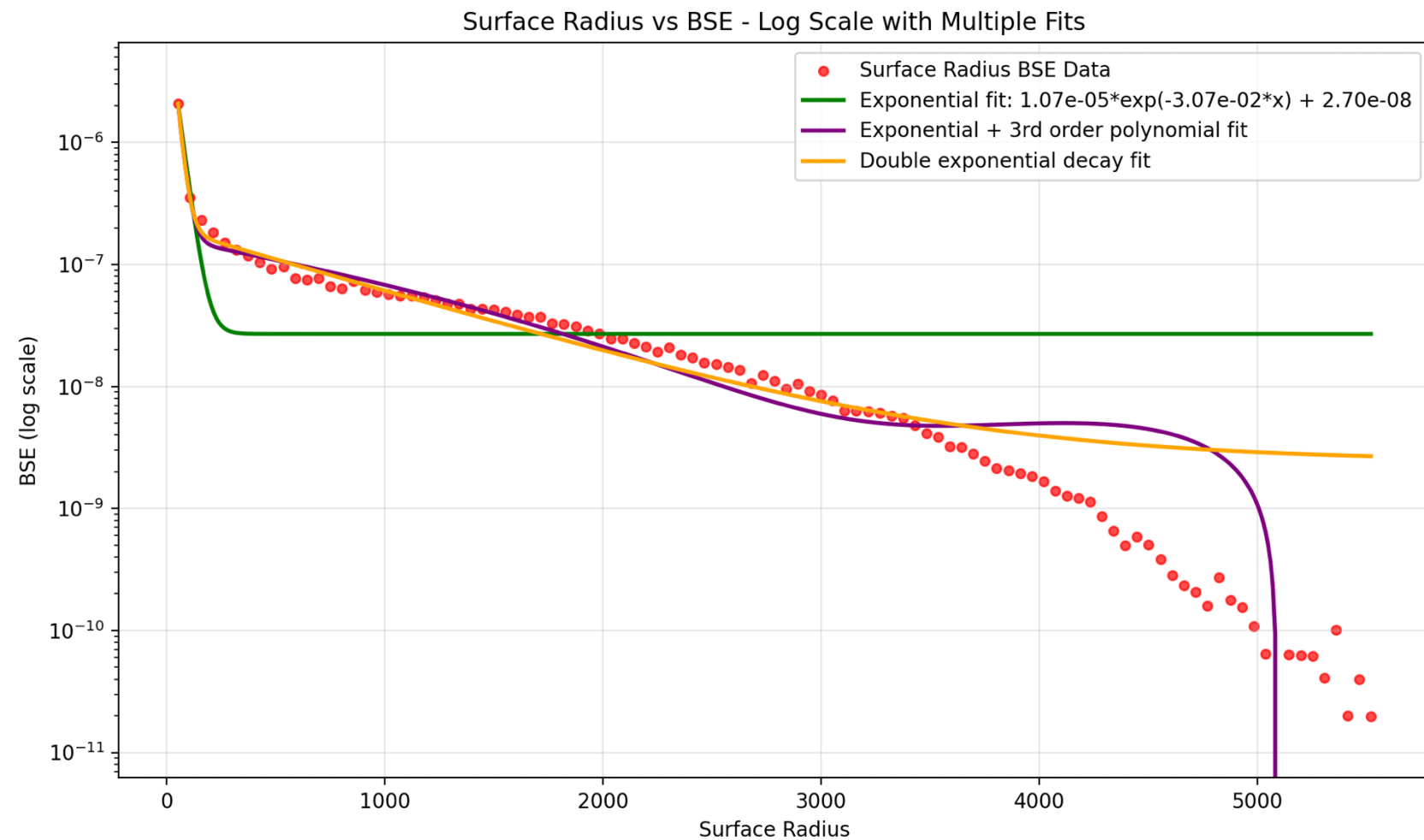


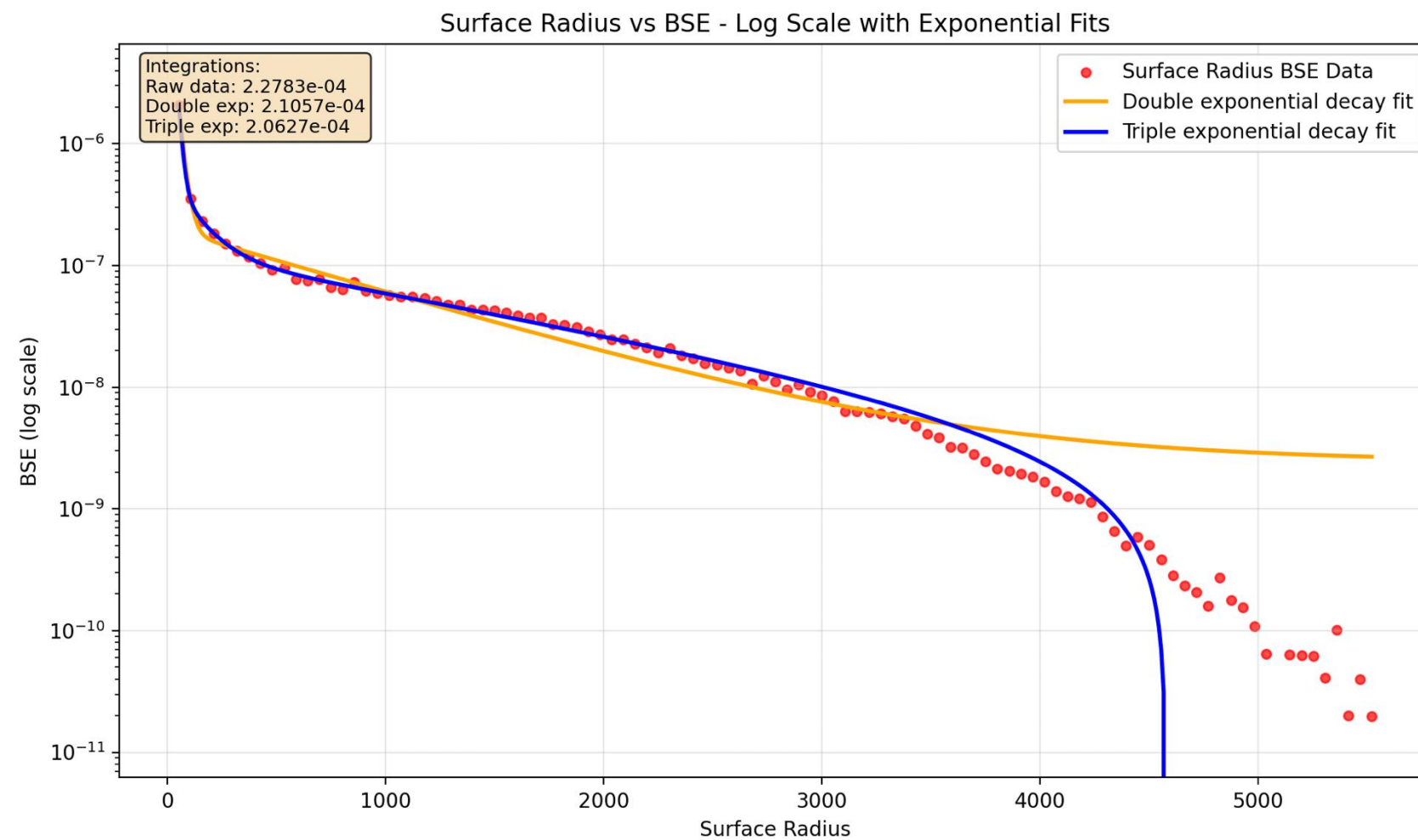
Figure 1



a few more fits



Figure 1

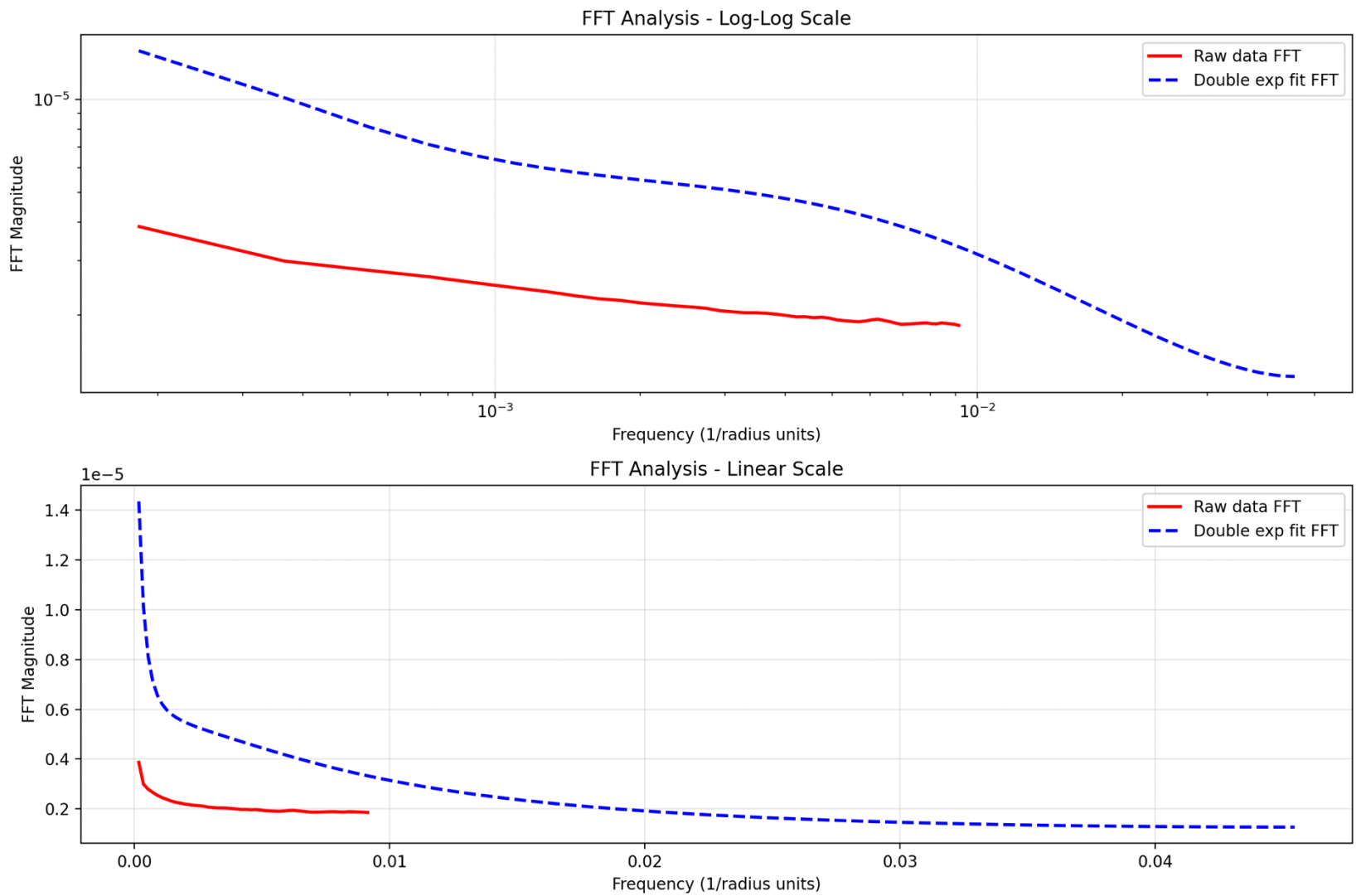


a couple of fits and some integration results





Figure 1



Fourier Transforms

